



Eat a brain a day

How eating the brains of their dead relatives led to the people of a once-isolated tribe develop immunity to various brain diseases? <http://dgit.in/eatabrain>



Industry Connect

I think to categorise it as cheaper is a mischaracterization. I think a lot of those brands that you mentioned, tend to have one flagship product, which tends to be today, Qualcomm. That decision tends to be driven by the fact that it's pivoted on having one platform that supports all the features globally. Today, MediaTek's modem technology isn't as advanced as Qualcomm's, the X20's modem is up to that level, but it's going to sample later this year, so we'll see what happens in 2016 with devices based on that.

d Moving on, like you said, calling it 'cheap' is a mischaracterization, don't you think that's because MediaTek doesn't market itself enough?

FM: Yes it's a factor for sure. MediaTek started to rebrand only a year and a half ago, at Barcelona last year. And you'll see us doing more. But to me, Snapdragon is almost synonymous with Qualcomm. For us though, Helio is going to define an experience, we'll have Helio and non-Helio products.

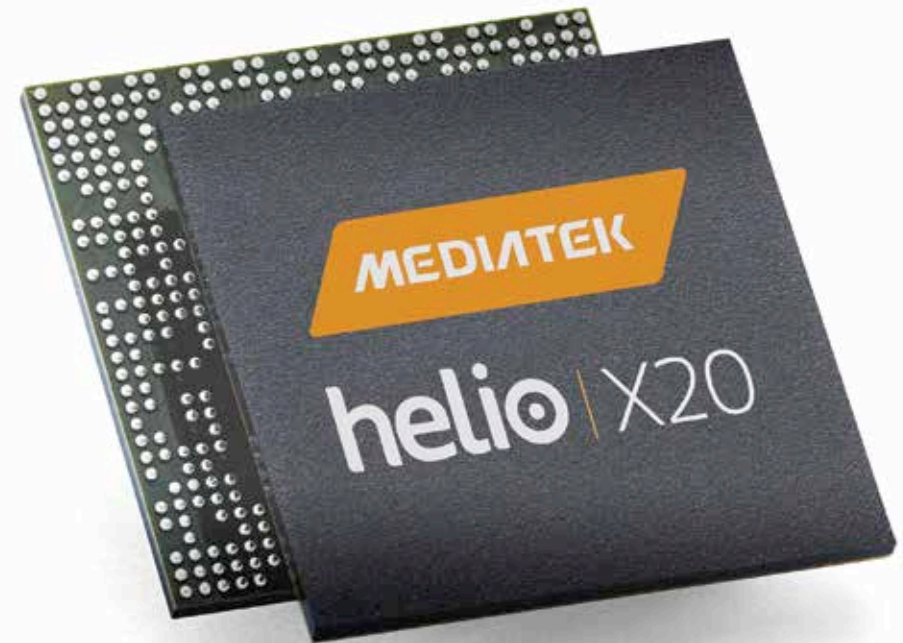
d And this would be the right time to do that right? You have your Helio X10, P10 and X20 right now. How else would you characterise them?

FM: Like I said, we'll concentrate on making Helio a sub-brand of MediaTek. I personally think that with the X10, P10 and X20 in that high and premium range, we now have the products that give a pretty good run for their money to Qualcomm.

d But it seems like you're still waiting for the products to prove that?

FM: Well, the P10 and X20 haven't shipped yet, so yes that's true. Those battles are being fought now, and the devices won't show up till next year. I think we've changed a lot, in the past we wouldn't have told anyone about the P10 and X20 before they actually came to the market on products, but now we're talking about it six months in advance.

That's also a reflection of our changed position. Because if you're only focused on mainstream and entry devices, they move pretty quickly. But focusing on flagships, the development cycles take more



time, and there's a longer cycle. So they tend to promote earlier as well.

d Both Intel and Samsung have worked on the 14nm processes already. Are you also working on the same?

FM: Yes, of course we do. Next year sometime. We announced X20 recently, so you can expect what comes next to be on the 14nm process.

d We've got feedback from a lot of people that MediaTek SoCs don't get custom ROMs. Why is that? Is it because of something on MediaTek's end?

FM: I don't think so. We're very open to working with that community if they want to, and we're open to supporting that. I think it's something on the ROM developers' end.

d Coming back to the SoCs, heating is a big issue in India. But if you look at processors, they are still developed based in colder regions, which means automatically there's less headroom for India. So if you're setting up R&D Centers in India, then why is this not being researched? Is it because it isn't possible at the moment?

FM: That's a good observation. Of course it's possible, it's ultimately physics. If your base is 45 degrees instead of 25 degrees, then you've already started

higher. I think all you can do then is work on all of the aspects that can reduce the power consumption. For example, we would argue that with our CorePilot algorithm in the Helio X20, if properly used, you use the right core for the right job. So it can reduce the power consumption by about 30%.

d In terms of the brands that are associated with the MediaTek, how big a role do Chinese brands play in your future?

FM: Six of the top 10 smartphone brands today are Chinese brands, so inevitably they are an important factor in the market going forward. But you know, now Micromax starts to bubble into that top 10-12 level, so it's like watch this space, right? I think for anybody in this business, the Chinese brands are going to be a big factor in this market globally, that's just how it is.

d Do you see a Samsung losing its grasp on the market in say 5 years?

FM: I can't predict what's going to happen in the market in a year, let alone five years. I expect more growth from the China brands, at the expense of who, I can't predict. **d**

To check out the complete interview either Blipp this page or visit - <http://dgit.in/mtek-moynihan>